

ANCIENT ROME TIMELINE

c. 1000 BCE

First villages on the hills of Rome.

753 BCE

Legendary founding of Rome.

c. 753–509 BCE

Rome is ruled by kings.

509 BCE

Last king is overthrown; Roman Republic begins.

390 BCE

Rome is ransacked by Gauls.

264 BCE

First gladiatorial contest in Rome.

264–146 BCE

Wars against Carthage, North Africa.

214–146 BCE

Wars against Greece.

73–71 BCE

Spartacus, a gladiator, leads a rebellion of 70,000 slaves against Rome.

58–51 BCE

Julius Caesar conquers Gaul.

44 BCE

After winning a civil war, Julius Caesar is declared dictator for life. A few weeks later, he is assassinated.

27 BCE

Roman Republic ends. Octavian becomes the first Roman emperor (Augustus). Roman Empire begins.

43 CE

Conquest of Britain begins.

60 CE

Queen Boudicca leads a rebellion in Britain against the Roman invaders.

64 CE

Fire destroys much of Rome. Nero begins the persecution of Christians.

68–69 CE

After Nero's death, power struggles lead to civil war.

79 CE

Destruction of Roman towns by the eruption of the volcano Vesuvius.

80 CE

Colosseum opens in Rome.

c. 120 CE

Roman Empire at its greatest extent.

120–128 CE

Hadrian's Wall is built in Britain.

271 CE

Wall is built around Rome.

284 CE

Roman Empire splits into Eastern and Western parts.

313 CE

Constantine, Rome's first Christian emperor, allows Christians—previously punished as criminals—to worship freely.

326 CE

Constantine ends gladiatorial combat as a sentence for crime.

330 CE

Constantinople (Istanbul) becomes the "New Rome" in the east—the capital of the Roman world.

c. 400 CE

Last known gladiatorial contest at the Colosseum.

410 CE

Rome is ransacked by Goths.

476 CE

Abdication of Romulus Augustulus, last emperor of the Western Empire.

476–1453 CE

Eastern Empire flourishes for 1,000 years, until Constantinople is conquered by the Turks.